A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE

MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

15 May 2026

Prof Matthew Read
Epworth Freemasons

Dear Prof Read,

Re: Mr Nathan Poratt
DOB: 07/04/1960 Phone: 0418 343 608
Address: 23 Royal Parade, Caulfield South, VIC, 3162
Email: natsue88@bigpond.com

Summary

- **Cessation of amitriptyline due to intolerable side effects including headaches, dizziness, and rapid weight gain.**
- **Trial of an alternative neuromodulator at a low dose to improve tolerability.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of conducting a quick phone review with Nathan. He contacted me to advise that he has ceased the amitriptyline I recently initiated. Unfortunately, he experienced a range of significant side effects, including persistent headaches, dizziness, a dry mouth, and a rapid weight gain of approximately three to four kilograms over the past ten days.

Nathan reported significant abdominal bloating and a feeling of being "huge," which has been quite distressing for him. While such rapid weight gain is atypical for a low dose of amitriptyline over a short duration, the timeframe suggests a potential fluid-related component. Given the impact on his quality of life, I agree with his decision to stop the medication.

Impression and Plan My clinical assessment of Nathan's condition remains the same, but we will need to pivot our pharmacological strategy to find an agent he can tolerate. I have prescribed a related neuromodulator but have opted for a very cautious titration schedule. I have asked Nathan to start with half a tablet to assess his sensitivity. If he remains free of side effects, he may then increase to a full tablet. I have counselled him that while dry mouth or changes in sleep patterns can occur, I am hopeful this alternative and the lower starting dose will avoid the headaches and weight gain he experienced previously. I have provided the prescription to him directly.

Yours sincerely,

A/Prof Chamara Basnayake
Gastroenterologist

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065

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CC: Dr Nava Ferdowsi

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